New Winners at the New York City Marathon

From: NPR World Mined: 2026-11-02 5 min read

Sweden's Andreas Almgren won the men's race at the New York City Marathon on Sunday in his very first try at the 26.2-mile distance, after a successful career running **half-marathons**. He pulled away from Italy's Yemaneberhan Crippa in the final mile to win in 2:06:01, with Crippa 13 seconds behind and Kamohelo Mofolo of Lesotho third, edging **defending champion** Benson Kipruto.

His time was the third fastest in course history, and the top seven finishers all ran among the ten fastest times ever there. He was the first debut winner since Gebre Gebremariam of Ethiopia in 2010, and American Zouhair Talbi finished sixth in the fastest time ever by a U.S. runner.

Kenya's Sheila Chepkirui won the women's race for the second time, also winning in 2024, pulling away from countrywoman Hellen Obiri in the final 150 meters to win in 2:24:36. American Jessica McClain passed Obiri, a two-time winner, in the final **strides** for second, six seconds behind, the first U.S. woman in the top three since 2018.

It was the 50th time the race has run through all five **boroughs**. In 1976 there were just over 2,000 competitors, including only 88 women; on Sunday about 60,000 runners started, nearly half women, from more than 140 countries. The marathon began in 1970 inside Central Park, where runners **looped** for its first six years.

For the first time in 15 years the course changed slightly at Mile 20, cutting Bronx turns from seven to five and easing street closures. In the wheelchair races, Switzerland's Marcel Hug won the men's race for the eighth time, passing Daniel Romanchuk in the final 100 meters by just over a second, and Catherine Debrunner won the women's race in 1:40:02, the second-fastest time ever.

Word Treasure

boroughs -- A part of a big city, like one of the five parts of New York City.
defending champion -- The runner who won the race last time and is trying to win again.
half-marathons -- A race that is half as long as a full marathon.
strides -- Long steps taken while running fast.
looped -- Went around in circles, coming back to the same place.

Background you need

A marathon is a long-distance running race of 26.2 miles.

The New York City Marathon is a famous race through the streets of New York City, with runners from many countries taking part.

Runners race along a set course, and the fastest man and woman win their races.

Wheelchair racers compete in their own races on the same course.

Break it down

LEAD: New winners at the New York City Marathon
KEY EVENT: Almgren wins the men's race in his marathon debut
+- WHO: Andreas Almgren of Sweden
+- WHEN: Sunday
+- RESULT: 2:06:01, third fastest in course history
KEY EVENT: Chepkirui wins the women's race for the second time
+- WHO: Sheila Chepkirui of Kenya
+- RESULT: 2:24:36, six seconds ahead of Jessica McClain
BACKGROUND: The race began in 1970 in Central Park and now runs through all five boroughs
WHEELCHAIR RACES: Marcel Hug and Catherine Debrunner won

Why it matters

Big races show how years of training and a strong finish can pay off, and how one city event can bring together runners from all over the world.

Test what you remember

1. Who won the men's race at the New York City Marathon?

- (A) Andreas Almgren
- (B) Benson Kipruto
- (C) Yemaneberhan Crippa
- (D) Zouhair Talbi

2. Who finished third in the men's race?

- (A) Kamohelo Mofolo
- (B) Yemaneberhan Crippa
- (C) Zouhair Talbi
- (D) Benson Kipruto

3. Who won the women's race?

- (A) Sheila Chepkirui
- (B) Hellen Obiri
- (C) Jessica McClain
- (D) Catherine Debrunner

4. About how many runners started the race on Sunday?

- (A) About 60,000
- (B) Nearly half
- (C) 88
- (D) Just over 2,000

5. Where did the marathon begin in 1970?

- (A) All five boroughs
- (B) Central Park
- (C) Mile 20
- (D) The Bronx

6. Who won the men's wheelchair race?

- (A) Marcel Hug
- (B) Zouhair Talbi
- (C) Benson Kipruto
- (D) Daniel Romanchuk

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: A 2: A 3: A 4: A 5: B 6: A

Questions to think about

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):